



2. Response Documentation

Objective

Document incident response procedures, investigation activities, and lessons learned.

Tools Used:

- Google Docs
- Draw.io

Task 1 – Incident Response Template

Executive Summary

On 18 August 2025, a phishing email targeted employees in the finance department. One user clicked a malicious link that attempted credential theft. The SOC team detected suspicious login activity and initiated incident response procedures to isolate the affected endpoint and prevent lateral movement.

2.Timeline

Timestamp	Action
2025-08-18 14:00:00	Isolated endpoint
2025-08-18 14:30:00	Collected memory dump
2025-08-18 15:00:00	Reset user credentials
2025-08-18 16:00:00	Blocked malicious domain

3.Impact Analysis

One employee workstation was affected. No evidence of data exfiltration was identified. Temporary disruption occurred during endpoint isolation and credential reset procedures.

4.Remediation Steps:

- Isolated compromised endpoint
- Reset affected user passwords



- Blocked phishing domain and sender
- Updated email filtering policies
- Conducted malware scan on affected systems

5.Lessons Learned

The incident highlighted the importance of user awareness training and rapid detection capabilities. Improvements are needed in phishing simulation exercises, email filtering rules, and incident escalation procedures to reduce response time and minimize organizational risk.

The screenshot shows a Google Docs document titled "Mock Phishing Incident Response". The document content is as follows:

Mock Phishing Incident Response

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Task 2 – Investigation Steps Log

Log actions for a mock incident:

The screenshot shows a Google Docs document titled "Investigation Log". The document content is as follows:

Investigation Log

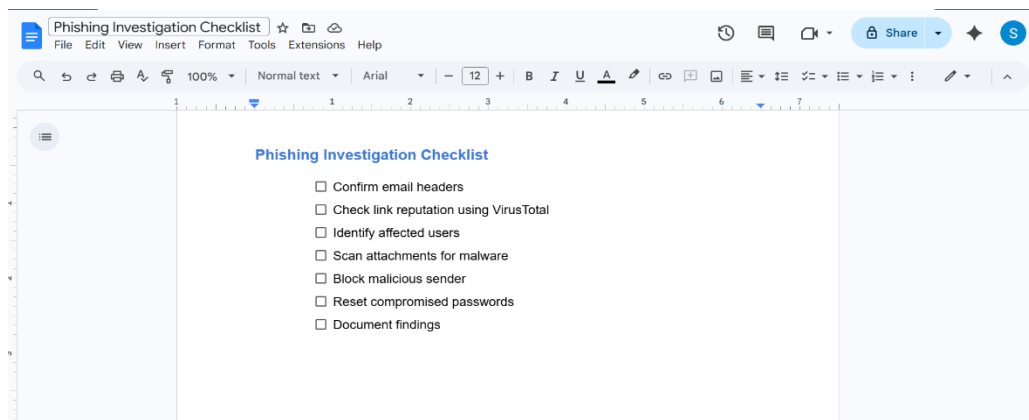
Timestamp	Action
2025-08-18 14:00:00	Isolated endpoint
2025-08-18 14:30:00	Collected memory dump
2025-08-18 15:00:00	Reviewed firewall logs
2025-08-18 15:30:00	Checked suspicious IP reputation
2025-08-18 16:00:00	Closed incident

Task 3 – Phishing Investigation Checklist



Checklist

- ✓ Confirm email headers
- ✓ Check link reputation using VirusTotal
- ✓ Identify affected users
- ✓ Review email gateway logs
- ✓ Collect endpoint logs
- ✓ Isolate affected endpoint
- ✓ Reset user credentials
- ✓ Document incident timeline



Task 4 – Post-Mortem Summary

The simulated phishing breach revealed delays in user reporting and inconsistent escalation procedures. Improved security awareness training, faster alert triage, and updated response playbooks are recommended. Regular phishing simulations and centralized logging will enhance detection, reduce response time, and improve coordination between SOC analysts and IT teams.

